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Turbine engine including a steam system

Abstract

A turbine engine for an aircraft including a turbo-engine, a fan having a fan shaft coupled to the turbo-engine, and a steam system. The steam system is fluidly coupled to a core air flow path at a plurality of steam injection locations to selectively inject steam into the core air flow path at each of the plurality of steam injection locations, using a steam flow control valve. The plurality of steam injection locations include (i) an upstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path at a primary combustion zone of a combustor or upstream thereof and (ii) a downstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path downstream of the primary combustion zone.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a divisional of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/538,037 filed on Dec. 13, 2023, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to turbine engines including a steam system.

BACKGROUND

(2) Turbine engines used in aircraft generally include a fan and a core section arranged in flow communication with one another. A combustor is arranged in the core section to generate combustion gases for driving a turbine in the core section of the turbine engine.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Features and advantages of the present disclosure will be apparent from the following description of various exemplary embodiments, as illustrated in the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numbers generally indicate identical, functionally similar, and/or structurally similar elements.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic cross-sectional diagram of a turbine engine including a steam system, taken along a longitudinal centerline axis of the turbine engine, according to the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of the turbine engine and the steam system of FIG. 1, according to the present disclosure.

- (4) FIG. 3A is a detail view, showing detail 3A in FIG. 1, of a portion of the turbine engine shown in FIG. 1. FIG. 3A shows a steam injection system according to a preferred embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 3B is a detail view of a portion of the turbine engine showing a steam injection system according to another preferred embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 4 is a detail view of a portion of the turbine engine showing a steam injection system according to another preferred embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 5 is a detail view of a portion of the turbine engine showing a steam injection system according to another preferred embodiment.
- (8) FIG. 6 is a detail view of a portion of the turbine engine showing a steam injection system according to another preferred embodiment.
- (9) FIG. 7 is a detail view of a portion of the turbine engine showing a steam injection system according to another preferred embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (10) Features, advantages, and embodiments of the present disclosure are set forth or apparent from a consideration of the following detailed description, drawings, and claims. Moreover, the following detailed description is exemplary and intended to provide further explanation without limiting the scope of the disclosure as claimed.
- (11) Various embodiments are discussed in detail below. While specific embodiments are discussed, this is done for illustration purposes only. A person skilled in the relevant art will recognize that other components and configurations may be used without departing from the spirit and the scope of the present disclosure.
- (12) As used herein, the terms “first,” “second,” and the like, may be used interchangeably to distinguish one component from another and are not intended to signify location or importance of the individual components.
- (13) The terms “forward” and “aft” refer to relative positions within a gas turbine engine or vehicle, and refer to the normal operational attitude of the gas turbine engine or vehicle. For example, with regard to a gas turbine engine, forward refers to a position closer to an engine inlet, and aft refers to a position closer to an engine nozzle or an exhaust.
- (14) The terms “upstream” and “downstream” refer to the relative direction with respect to fluid flow in a fluid pathway. For example, “upstream” refers to the direction from which the fluid flows, and “downstream” refers to the direction to which the fluid flows.
- (15) The terms “coupled,” “fixed,” “attached,” “connected,” and the like, refer to both direct coupling, fixing, attaching, or connecting, as well as indirect coupling, fixing, attaching, or connecting through one or more intermediate components or features, unless otherwise specified herein.
- (16) As used herein, the terms “axial” and “axially” refer to directions and orientations that extend substantially parallel to a centerline of the turbine engine. Moreover, the terms “radial” and “radially” refer to directions and orientations that extend substantially perpendicular to the centerline of the turbine engine. In addition, as used herein, the terms “circumferential” and “circumferentially” refer to directions and orientations that extend arcuately about the centerline of the turbine engine.
- (17) References to “inner” and “outer” when discussed in the context of radial directions refer to positions relative to the longitudinal centerline of the component.
- (18) As used herein, a “bypass ratio” of a turbine engine is a ratio of bypass air through a bypass of the turbine engine to core air through a core inlet of a turbo-engine of the turbine engine.
- (19) As used herein, a “compression ratio” of a compressor is a ratio of a compressor exit pressure at an exit of the compressor to a compressor inlet pressure at an inlet of the compressor. The compressor exit pressure and the compressor inlet pressure are measured as static air pressures perpendicular to the direction of the core air flow through the compressor.
- (20) As used herein, a “pressure expansion ratio” of a turbine is a ratio of a pressure at an inlet of

the turbine to a pressure at an exit of the turbine.

(21) The singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

(22) Here and throughout the specification and claims, range limitations are combined and interchanged. Such ranges are identified and include all the sub-ranges contained therein unless context or language indicates otherwise. For example, all ranges disclosed herein are inclusive of the endpoints, and the endpoints are independently combinable with each other.

(23) As noted above, a combustor is arranged in the core section of the turbine engine to generate combustion gases for driving a turbine in the core section. Not all of the energy and heat generated by the combustor is used to drive the turbine(s) of the turbine section. Instead, some of the waste heat is exhausted through a jet exhaust nozzle section in a conventional turbine engine. The turbine engine discussed herein includes a steam system that is used to recover some of the energy from the waste heat by generating steam and driving a steam turbine. After flowing through the steam turbine, the steam may be injected into a core air flow path and, more specifically, into the combustor. To achieve greater benefits of the increased mass flow within the core air flow, the steam is preferably injected into the core air in a range of 20% to 50% of the mass flow through the core air flow path. While some steam flowing through a primary combustion zone of the combustor is beneficial, steam at these mass flows (or water-to-air ratios) may result in flame stability issues and flame dynamics issues during combustion of the fuel, particularly, for highly reactive fuels such as diatomic hydrogen. Instead, as discussed herein, the steam may be injected into the core air flow path at a plurality of locations with a portion of the steam flowing through the primary combustion zone. In this way, the water-to-air ratio of the primary air flowing through the primary combustion zone can be maintained at a level low enough for good flame performance.

(24) Referring now to the drawings, FIG. 1 is a schematic cross-sectional diagram of a turbine engine 10 including a steam system 100, taken along a longitudinal centerline axis 12 (provided for reference) of the turbine engine 10, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 1, the turbine engine 10 has an axial direction A (extending parallel to the longitudinal centerline axis 12) and a radial direction R that is normal to the axial direction A. In general, the turbine engine 10 includes a fan section 14 and a turbo-engine 16 disposed downstream from the fan section 14.

(25) The turbo-engine 16 includes, in serial flow relationship, a compressor section 21, a combustion section 26, and a turbine section 27. The turbo-engine 16 is substantially enclosed within an outer casing 18 that is substantially tubular and defines a core inlet 20, which, as depicted in FIG. 1, may be annular. As schematically shown in FIG. 1, the compressor section 21 includes a booster or a low-pressure compressor (LPC) 22 followed downstream by a high-pressure compressor (HPC) 24. The combustion section 26 is downstream of the compressor section 21. The turbine section 27 is downstream of the combustion section 26 and includes a high-pressure turbine (HPT) 28 followed downstream by a low-pressure turbine (LPT) 30. The turbo-engine 16 further includes a jet exhaust nozzle section 32 that is downstream of the turbine section 27, a high-pressure (HP) shaft 34 or a spool, and a low-pressure (LP) shaft 36. The compressor section 21, the combustor 26, the turbine section 27, and the one or more core exhaust nozzles 32 together define a core air flow path 33. The HP shaft 34 drivingly connects the HPT 28 to the HPC 24. The HPT 28 and the HPC 24 rotate in unison through the HP shaft 34. The LP shaft 36 drivingly connects the LPT 30 to the LPC 22. The LPT 30 and the LPC 22 rotate in unison through the LP shaft 36.

(26) For the embodiment depicted in FIG. 1, the fan section 14 includes a fan 38 (e.g., a variable pitch fan) having a plurality of fan blades 40 coupled to a disk 42 in a spaced apart manner. As depicted in FIG. 1, the fan blades 40 extend outwardly from the disk 42 generally along the radial direction R. In the case of a variable pitch fan, the plurality of fan blades 40 are rotatable relative to the disk 42 about a pitch axis P by virtue of the fan blades 40 being operatively coupled to an actuator 44 configured to collectively vary the pitch of the fan blades 40 in unison. The fan blades

40, the disk **42**, and the actuator **44** are together rotatable about the longitudinal centerline axis **12** via a fan shaft **45** that is powered by the LP shaft **36** across a power gearbox, also referred to as a gearbox assembly **46**. In this way, the fan **38** is drivingly coupled to, and powered by, the turbo-engine **16**, and the turbine engine **10** is an indirect drive engine. The gearbox assembly **46** is shown schematically in FIG. **1**. The gearbox assembly **46** may be reduction gearbox assembly including a plurality of gears for adjusting the rotational speed of the fan shaft **45** and, thus, the fan **38** relative to the LP shaft **36** when power is transferred from the LP shaft **36** to the fan shaft **45**.

(27) Referring still to the exemplary embodiment of FIG. **1**, the disk **42** is covered by a rotatable fan hub **48** aerodynamically contoured to promote an airflow through the plurality of fan blades **40**. In addition, the fan section **14** includes an annular fan casing or a nacelle **50** that circumferentially surrounds the fan **38** and/or at least a portion of the turbo-engine **16**. The nacelle **50** is supported relative to the turbo-engine **16** by a plurality of circumferentially spaced outlet guide vanes **52**. Moreover, a downstream section **54** of the nacelle **50** extends over an outer portion of the turbo-engine **16**, and, with the outer casing **18**, define, a bypass airflow passage **56** therebetween. The one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** may extend through the nacelle **50** and be formed therein. In this embodiment, the one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** include one or more discrete nozzles that are spaced circumferentially about the nacelle **50**. Other arrangements of the one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** may be used including, for example, a single core exhaust nozzle that is annular, or partially annular, about the nacelle **50**.

(28) During operation of the turbine engine **10**, a volume of air **58** enters the turbine engine **10** through an inlet **60** of the nacelle **50** and/or the fan section **14**. As the volume of air **58** passes across the fan blades **40**, a first portion of air, also referred to as bypass air **62**, is directed or routed into the bypass airflow passage **56**, and a second portion of air, also referred to as core air **64**, is directed or is routed into the upstream section of the core air flow path **33** through the core inlet **20**. The ratio between the bypass air **62** and the core air **64** is known as a bypass ratio. In some embodiments, the bypass ratio is greater than 18:1, enabled by a steam system **100**, detailed further below. The pressure of the core air **64** is then increased by the LPC **22**, generating compressed air **65**. The compressed air **65** is routed through the HPC **24** and further compressed before being directed into the combustor **26**, where the compressed air **65** is mixed with fuel **67** and ignited to generate combustion gases **66** (combustion products). One or more stages may be used in each of the LPC **22** and the HPC **24**, with each subsequent stage further compressing the compressed air **65**. The HPC **24** has a compression ratio greater than 20:1, preferably, in a range of 20:1 to 40:1. The compression ratio is a ratio of a pressure of a last stage of the HPC **24** to a pressure of a first stage of the HPC **24**. The compression ratio greater than 20:1 is enabled by the steam system **100**, as detailed further below.

(29) The combustion gases **66** are routed into the HPT **28** and expanded through the HPT **28** where a portion of thermal energy and/or kinetic energy from the combustion gases **66** is extracted via one or more stages of HPT stator vanes **68** and HPT rotor blades **70** that are coupled to the HP shaft **34**. This causes the HP shaft **34** to rotate, thereby supporting operation of the HPC **24** (self-sustaining cycle). In this way, the combustion gases **66** do work on the HPT **28**. The combustion gases **66** are then routed into the LPT **30** and expanded through the LPT **30**. Here, a second portion of thermal energy and/or the kinetic energy is extracted from the combustion gases **66** via one or more stages of LPT stator vanes **72** and LPT rotor blades **74** that are coupled to the LP shaft **36**. This causes the LP shaft **36** to rotate, thereby supporting operation of the LPC **22** (self-sustaining cycle) and rotation of the fan **38** via the gearbox assembly **46**. In this way, the combustion gases **66** do work on the LP turbine **30**. One or more stages may be used in each of the HPT **28** and the LPT **30**. The HPC **24** having a compression ratio in a range of 20:1 to 40:1 results in the HPT **28** having a pressure expansion ratio in a range of 1.5:1 to 4:1 and the LPT **30** having a pressure expansion ratio in a range of 4.5:1 to 28:1.

(30) The combustion gases **66**, after being routed through the steam system **100** (as discussed

below), are subsequently routed through the one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** of the turbo-engine **16** to provide propulsive thrust. Simultaneously with the flow of the core air **64** through the core air flow path **33**, the bypass air **62** is routed through the bypass airflow passage **56** before being exhausted from a fan bypass nozzle **76** of the turbine engine **10**, also providing propulsive thrust. The HPT **28**, the LPT **30**, and the one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** at least partially define a hot gas path **78** for routing the combustion gases **66** through the turbo-engine **16**.

(31) As noted above, the compressed air **65** (the core air **64**) is mixed with the fuel **67** in the combustor **26** to form a fuel and air mixture, and combusted, generating combustion gases **66** (combustion products). The fuel **67** can include any type of fuel used for turbine engines, such as, for example, sustainable aviation fuels (SAF) including biofuels, JetA, or other hydrocarbon fuels. The fuel **67** also may be a hydrogen-based fuel (H.sub.2), and, while hydrogen-based fuel may include blends with hydrocarbon fuels, the fuel **67** used herein is preferably unblended, and referred to herein as hydrogen fuel. In some embodiments, the hydrogen fuel may comprise substantially pure hydrogen molecules (i.e., diatomic hydrogen). The fuel **67** may also be a cryogenic fuel. For example, when the hydrogen fuel is used, the hydrogen fuel may be stored in a liquid phase at cryogenic temperatures.

(32) The turbine engine **10** includes a fuel system **80** for providing the fuel **67** to the combustor **26**. The fuel system **80** includes a fuel tank **82** for storing the fuel **67** therein, and a fuel delivery assembly **84**. The fuel tank **82** can be located on an aircraft (not shown) to which the turbine engine **10** is attached. While a single fuel tank **82** is shown in FIG. **1**, the fuel system **80** can include any number of fuel tanks **82**, as desired. The fuel delivery assembly **84** delivers the fuel **67** from the fuel tank **82** to the combustor **26**. The fuel delivery assembly **84** includes one or more lines, conduits, pipes, tubes, etc., configured to carry the fuel **67** from the fuel tank **82** to the combustor **26**. The fuel delivery assembly **84** also includes a pump **86** to induce the flow of the fuel **67** through the fuel delivery assembly **84** to the combustor **26**. In this way, the pump **86** pumps the fuel **67** from the fuel tank **82**, through the fuel delivery assembly **84**, and into the combustor **26**. The fuel system **80** and, more specifically, the fuel tank **82** and the fuel delivery assembly **84**, either collectively or individually, may be a fuel source for the combustor **26**.

(33) In some embodiments, for example, when the fuel **67** is a hydrogen fuel, the fuel system **80** includes one or more vaporizers **88** (illustrated by dashed lines) and a metering valve **90** (illustrated by dashed lines) in fluid communication with the fuel delivery assembly **84**. In this example, the hydrogen fuel is stored in the fuel tank **82** as liquid hydrogen fuel. The one or more vaporizers **88** heat the liquid hydrogen fuel flowing through the fuel delivery assembly **84**. The one or more vaporizers **88** are positioned in the flow path of the fuel **67** between the fuel tank **82** and the combustor **26**, and are located downstream of the pump **86**. The one or more vaporizers **88** are in thermal communication with at least one heat source, such as, for example, waste heat from the turbine engine **10** and/or from one or more systems of the aircraft (not shown). The one or more vaporizers **88** heat the liquid hydrogen fuel and the liquid hydrogen fuel is converted into a gaseous hydrogen fuel within the one or more vaporizers **88**. The fuel delivery assembly **84** directs the gaseous hydrogen fuel into the combustor **26**.

(34) The metering valve **90** is positioned downstream of the one or more vaporizers **88** and the pump **86**. The metering valve **90** receives hydrogen fuel in a substantially completely gaseous phase, or in a substantially completely supercritical phase. The metering valve **90** provides the flow of fuel to the combustor **26** in a desired manner. More specifically, the metering valve **90** provides a desired volume of hydrogen fuel at, for example, a desired flow rate, to a fuel manifold that includes one or more fuel injectors that inject the hydrogen fuel into the combustor **26**. The fuel system **80** can include any components for supplying the fuel **67** from the fuel tank **82** to the combustor **26**, as desired.

(35) The turbine engine **10** includes the steam system **100** in fluid communication with the one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** and the fan bypass nozzle **76**. The steam system **100** extracts steam

from the combustion gases **66** as the combustion gases **66** flow through the steam system **100**, as detailed further below.

(36) The turbine engine **10** depicted in FIG. **1** is by way of example only. In other exemplary embodiments, the turbine engine **10** may have any other suitable configuration. For example, in other exemplary embodiments, the fan **38** may be configured in any other suitable manner (e.g., as a fixed pitch fan) and further may be supported using any other suitable fan frame configuration. Moreover, in other exemplary embodiments, any other suitable number or configuration of compressors, turbines, shafts, or a combination thereof may be provided. In still other exemplary embodiments, aspects of the present disclosure may be incorporated into any other suitable turbine engine, such as, for example, turbofan engines, propfan engines, and/or turboprop engines.

(37) FIG. **2** is a schematic diagram of the turbine engine **10** and the steam system **100** of FIG. **1**, according to the present disclosure. For clarity, the turbine engine **10** is shown schematically in FIG. **2** and some components are not shown in FIG. **2**. The steam system **100** includes a boiler **102**, a condenser **104**, a water separator **106**, a water pump **108**, and a steam turbine **110**.

(38) The boiler **102** is a heat exchanger that vaporizes liquid water from a water source to generate steam or water vapor, as detailed further below. The boiler **102** is thus a steam source. In particular, the boiler **102** is an exhaust gas-water heat exchanger. The boiler **102** is in fluid communication with the hot gas path **78** (FIG. **1**) and is positioned downstream of the LPT **30**. The boiler **102** is also in fluid communication with the water pump **108**, as detailed further below. The boiler **102** can include any type of boiler or heat exchanger for extracting heat from the combustion gases **66** and vaporizing liquid water into steam or water vapor as the liquid water and the combustion gases **66** flow through the boiler **102**.

(39) The condenser **104** is a heat exchanger that further cools the combustion gases **66** as the combustion gases **66** flow through the condenser **104**, as detailed further below. In particular, the condenser **104** is an air-exhaust gas heat exchanger. The condenser **104** is in fluid communication with the boiler **102** and is positioned within the bypass airflow passage **56**. The condenser **104** can include any type of condenser for condensing water (e.g., in liquid form) from the exhaust (e.g., the combustion gases **66**).

(40) The water separator **106** is in fluid communication with the condenser **104** for receiving cooled exhaust (combustion gases **66**) having condensed water entrained therein. The water separator **106** is also in fluid communication with the one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** and with the water pump **108**. The water separator **106** includes any type of water separator for separating water from the exhaust. For example, the water separator **106** can include a cyclonic separator that uses vortex separation to separate the water from the air. In such embodiments, the water separator **106** generates a cyclonic flow within the water separator **106** to separate the water from the cooled exhaust. In FIG. **2**, the water separator **106** is schematically depicted as being in the nacelle **50**, but the water separator **106** could be located at other locations within the turbine engine **10**, such as, for example, radially inward of the nacelle **50**, closer to the turbo-engine **16**. The water separator **106** may be driven to rotate by one of the engine shafts, such as the HP shaft **34** or the LP shaft **36**. As noted above, the boiler **102** receives liquid water from a water source to generate steam or water vapor. In the embodiment depicted in FIG. **2**, the condenser **104** and the water separator **106**, individually or collectively, are the water source for the boiler **102**.

(41) The water pump **108** is in fluid communication with the water separator **106** and with the boiler **102**. The water pump **108** is in fluid communication with the condenser **104** via the water separator **106**. The water pump **108** may be any suitable pump, such as a centrifugal pump or a positive displacement pump. The water pump **108** directs the separated liquid water **124** through the boiler **102** where the water **124** is converted back to steam. This steam is sent through the steam turbine **110**, and then injected into core air flow path **33**, such as into the combustor **26**.

(42) The steam system **100** depicted in FIG. **2** includes a water tank **112** fluidly connected to the water separator **106** to collect the water **124** condensed by the condenser **104** and separated by the

water separator **106**. The water tank **112** may be positioned between the water separator **106** and the water pump **108**. The water pump **108** may draw the water **124** from the water tank **112** and direct the water **124**, at a desired flow rate, into the boiler **102**. In some embodiments, however, the water tank **112** may be omitted from the steam system **100**.

(43) In operation, the combustion gases **66**, also referred to as exhaust, flow from the LPT **30** into the boiler **102**. The combustion gases **66** transfer heat into the water **124** (e.g., in liquid form) within the boiler **102**, as detailed further below. The combustion gases **66** then flow into the condenser **104**. The condenser **104** condenses the water **124** (e.g., in liquid form) from the combustion gases **66**. The bypass air **62** flows through the bypass airflow passage **56** and over or through the condenser **104** and extracts heat from the combustion gases **66**, cooling the combustion gases **66** and condensing the water **124** from the combustion gases **66**, to generate an exhaust-water mixture **120**. The bypass air **62** is then exhausted out of the turbine engine **10** through the fan bypass nozzle **76** to generate thrust, as detailed above. The condenser **104** thus may be positioned in bypass airflow passage **56**.

(44) The exhaust-water mixture **120** flows into the water separator **106**. The water separator **106** separates the water **124** from the exhaust of the exhaust-water mixture **120** to generate separate exhaust **122** and the water **124**. The exhaust **122** is exhausted out of the turbine engine **10** through the one or more core exhaust nozzles **32** to generate thrust, as detailed above. The boiler **102**, the condenser **104**, and the water separator **106** thus also define a portion of the hot gas path **78** (see FIG. **1**) for routing the combustion gases **66**, the exhaust-water mixture **120**, and the exhaust **122** through the steam system **100** of the turbine engine **10**.

(45) The water pump **108** pumps the water **124** (e.g., in liquid form) through one or more water lines (as indicated by the arrow for the water **124** in FIG. **2**) and the water **124** flows through the boiler **102**. As the water **124** flows through the boiler **102**, the combustion gases **66** flowing through the boiler **102** transfer heat into the water **124** to vaporize the water **124** and to generate steam **126** (e.g., vapor). The steam turbine **110** includes one or more stages of steam turbine blades (not shown) and steam turbine stators (not shown). The steam **126** flows from the boiler **102** into the steam turbine **110**, through one or more steam lines (as indicated by the arrow for the steam **126** in FIG. **2**), causing the steam turbine blades of the steam turbine **110** to rotate, thereby generating additional work in an output shaft (e.g., one of the engine shafts) connected to the turbine blades of the steam turbine **110**.

(46) As noted above, the turbo-engine **16** includes shafts, also referred to as engine shafts, coupling various rotating components of the turbo-engine **16** and other thrust producing components such as the fan **38**. In the turbo-engine **16** shown in FIG. **1**, these engine shafts include the HP shaft **34** and the LP shaft **36**. The steam turbine **110** is coupled to one of the engine shafts of the turbo-engine **16**, such as the HP shaft **34** or the LP shaft **36**. In the illustrated embodiment, the steam turbine **110** is coupled to the LP shaft **36**. As the steam **126** flows from the boiler **102** through the steam turbine **110**, the kinetic energy of this gas is converted by the steam turbine **110** into mechanical work in the LP shaft **36**. The reduced temperature steam (as steam **128**) exiting the steam turbine **110** is then injected into the core air flow path **33**, such as into the combustor **26**, upstream of the combustor **26**, or downstream of the combustor **26**. The steam **128** flows through one or more steam lines from the steam turbine **110** to the core air flow path **33**. The steam **128** injected into the core air flow path **33** adds mass flow to the core air **64** such that less core air **64** is needed to produce the same amount of work through the turbine section **27**. In this way, the steam system **100** extracts additional work from the heat in exhaust gas that would otherwise be wasted. The steam **128** injected into the core air flow path **33** is in a range of 20% to 50% of the mass flow through the core air flow path **33**.

(47) The steam turbine **110** may have a pressure expansion ratio in a range of 2:1 to 6:1. The pressure expansion ratio is a ratio of the pressure at an inlet of the steam turbine **110** to the pressure at an exit of the steam turbine **110**. The steam turbine **110** may contribute approximately 25% of the

power to the LP shaft **36** (or to the HP shaft **34**) when the steam system **100** recovers approximately 70% of the water **124** and converts the water **124** into the steam **126**. The steam turbine **110** has a pressure expansion ratio in a range of 2:1 to 6:1, the LPT **30** has a pressure expansion ratio in a range of 4.5:1 to 28:1, and the steam **128** contributes to 20% to 50% of the mass flow through the core air flow path **33**. The steam turbine **110** expands the steam **126**, thereby reducing the energy of the steam **128** exiting the steam turbine **110** and reducing the temperature of the steam **128** to approximately a temperature of the compressed air **65** (see FIG. 1) that is discharged from the HPC **24**. Such a configuration enables the steam **128** to reduce hot spots in the combustor **26** from the combustion of the fuel (e.g., in particular, when the fuel is supercritical hydrogen or gaseous hydrogen).

(48) The steam **128** injected into the core air flow path **33** also enables the HPT **28** to have a greater energy output with fewer stages of the HPT **28** as compared to HPTs without the benefit of the present disclosure. For example, the additional mass flow from the steam **128** through the turbine section **27** helps to produce a greater energy output. In this way, the HPT **28** may only have one stage capable of sustainably driving a greater number of stages of the HPC **24** (e.g., 10, 11, or 12 stages of the HPC **24**) due to the higher mass flow (resulting from the steam injection) exiting the combustor **26**. The steam **128** that is injected into the core air flow path **33** enables the HPT **28** to have only one stage that drives the plurality of stages of the HPC **24** without reducing an amount of work that the HPT **28** produces as compared to HPTs without the benefit of the present disclosure, while also reducing a weight of the HPT **28** and increasing an efficiency of the HPT **28**, as compared to HPTs without the benefit of the present disclosure.

(49) With less core air **64** (see FIG. 1) needed due to the added mass flow from the steam **126**, the compression ratio of the HPC **24** may be increased as compared to HPCs without the benefit of the present disclosure. In this way, the HPC **24** has a compression ratio greater than 20:1. In some embodiments, the compression ratio of the HPC **24** is in a range of 20:1 to 40:1. Thus, the compression ratio of the HPC **24** is increased, thereby increasing the thermal efficiency of the turbine engine **10** as compared to HPCs and turbine engines without the benefit of the present disclosure. Further, the HPC **24** may have a reduced throat area due to the added mass flow in the turbo-engine **16** provided by the steam **126**, **128** injected into the turbo-engine **16**. Accordingly, the HPC **24** has a reduced size (e.g., outer diameter) and a reduced weight, as compared to turbine engines without the benefit of the present disclosure.

(50) In some embodiments, the HPC stator vanes of at least two stages of the HPC **24** are variable stator vanes that are controlled to be pitched about a pitch axis to vary a pitch of the HPC stator vanes. In some embodiments, the HPC **24** includes one or more compressor bleed valves that are controlled to be opened to bleed a portion of the compressed air **65** (see FIG. 1) from the HPC **24**. The one or more compressor bleed valves are preferably positioned between a fourth stage of the HPC **24** and a last stage of the HPC **24**. The HPC stator vanes are variable stator vanes, and the one or more compressor bleed valves help to balance the air flow (e.g., the compressed air **65**) through all stages of the HPC **24**. Such a balance, in combination with the steam **128** injected into the core air flow path **33**, enables the number of stages of the HPC **24** to include ten to twelve stages for compression ratios to be greater than 20:1, and, preferably, in a range of 20:1 to 40:1.

(51) The additional work that is extracted by the steam system **100** and the steam **128** injected into the core air flow path **33** enables a size of the turbo-engine **16** (FIG. 1) to be reduced, thereby increasing the bypass ratio of the turbine engine **10**, as compared to turbine engines without the benefit of the present disclosure. In this way, the turbine engine **10** has a bypass ratio greater than 18:1, preferably, in a range of 18:1 to 100:1, more preferably, in a range of 25:1 to 85:1, and, most preferably, in a range of 28:1 to 70:1. In this way, the steam system **100** can enable an increased bypass ratio in which the turbine engine **10** can move a greater mass of air through the bypass, reducing the pressure ratio of the fan **38** and increasing the efficiency of the turbine engine **10** as compared to turbine engines without the benefit of the present disclosure.

(52) FIG. 3A is a detail view, showing detail 3A in FIG. 1, of a portion of the turbo-engine 16. More specifically, FIG. 3A shows the combustor 26, a portion of the HPC 24, the HPT 28, and a portion of the LPT 30. FIG. 3A also shows a first steam injection system 200 according to a preferred embodiment. The combustor 26 is an annular combustor (i.e., annular about the longitudinal centerline axis 12) that includes a combustion chamber 130 defined between an inner liner 132 and an outer liner 134. Each of the inner liner 132 and outer liner 134 is annular about the longitudinal centerline axis 12 of the turbine engine 10 (FIG. 1) and may thus extend in the circumferential direction of the turbine engine 10. The combustor 26 also includes a combustor case 136 that is also annular about the longitudinal centerline axis 12 of the turbine engine 10. The combustor case 136 extends circumferentially around the inner liner 132 and the outer liner 134, and the inner liner 132 and outer liner 134 are located radially inward of the combustor case 136. The combustor 26 also includes a dome 138 mounted to a forward end of each of the inner liner 132 and the outer liner 134. The dome 138 defines an upstream (or forward end) of the combustion chamber 130.

(53) A plurality of mixer assemblies 140 (only one is illustrated in FIG. 3A) are spaced around the dome 138. The plurality of mixer assemblies 140 are circumferentially spaced about the longitudinal centerline axis 12 of the turbine engine 10 (FIG. 1). The mixer assembly 140 may be a swirler/fuel nozzle assembly that includes a fuel nozzle 142 receiving the fuel 67 from the fuel delivery assembly 84 (FIG. 1). The fuel 67 is injected into the combustion chamber 130 through one or more orifices formed in the mixer assembly 140. The mixer assembly 140 may be any suitable mixer assembly including rich burn mixer assemblies or lean burn mixer assemblies, such as a twin annular premixing swirler (TAPS).

(54) As noted above, the compressor section 21, including the HPC 24, pressurizes air, and the combustor 26 receives an annular stream of this pressurized air from a discharge outlet (compressor discharge outlet 144) of the HPC 24. This air may be referred to as compressor discharge pressure air 150. The compressor discharge outlet 144 may be positioned to discharge the compressor discharge pressure air 150 into a mixing chamber 146, and then a portion of the compressor discharge pressure air 150 flows into the mixer assembly 140 as primary air 152. The mixer assembly 140 may include a plurality of swirler vanes as part of a swirler that is used to swirl and to generate turbulence in the primary air 152 flowing through the mixer assembly 140. The fuel nozzle 142 injects fuel 67 into the turbulent airflow of the primary air 152 and the turbulence promotes rapid mixing of the fuel 67 with the primary air 152, generating a fuel-air mixture.

(55) The fuel-air mixture is provided to the combustion chamber 130 from the mixer assembly 140 for combustion. Ignition of the fuel-air mixture is accomplished by an igniter 148, and the resulting combustion gases 66 flow in the axial direction A of the turbine engine 10 toward and into an annular turbine nozzle of the HPT 28. Much of the fuel 67 injected by the fuel nozzle 142 is combusted in a primary combustion zone 135 in the region of the combustion chamber 130 directly downstream of the mixer assembly 140. The turbine nozzle is defined by an annular flow channel that includes a plurality of radially extending, circumferentially-spaced HPT stator vanes 68 that turn the gases so that they flow angularly and impinge upon a plurality of HPT rotor blades 70 of a turbine rotor of the HPT 28. The HPT rotor blades 70 are circumferentially spaced, and the HPT stator vanes 68 are upstream of the HPT rotor blades 70. The rotor may be, for example, a disk or a blisk drivingly connected to the HP shaft 34. As discussed above, the steam system 100 enables the use of a single stage HPT 28 and only one stage is depicted in FIG. 3A, but other HPTs may be used including those with two or more stages.

(56) Another portion of the compressor discharge pressure air 150 is dilution air 154 (also referred to as secondary air). The dilution air 154 flows around the outside of the inner liner 132 and the outer liner 134, and is introduced into the combustion chamber 130 by one or more dilution holes 156 formed in the inner liner 132 and the outer liner 134 at positions downstream of the mixer assembly 140. The dilution air 154 helps quench combustion gases from the primary combustion

zone **135** before being introduced into the turbine section **27**. The dilution air **154** bypasses the primary combustion zone **135** and is introduced into the combustion chamber **130** downstream of the primary combustion zone **135**.

(57) A third portion of the compressor discharge pressure air **150** may be directed into the HPT **28** as HPT cooling air **158**. The HPT cooling air **158** may be drawn from the dilution air **154** and directed into the HPT rotor blades **70** and, more specifically, through cooling passages formed within the HPT rotor blades **70** to cool the HPT rotor blades **70**.

(58) The steam system **100** (FIG. 2) is fluidly coupled to the core air flow path **33** via a steam delivery assembly **212**. The steam delivery assembly **212** includes one or more lines, conduits, pipes, tubes, etc., configured to carry the steam **128** from the steam source, such as the boiler **102**, to the core air flow path **33**. The steam delivery assembly **212** is fluidly connected to the core air flow path **33** at a plurality of steam injection locations **220** to selectively inject the steam **128** into the core air flow path **33** at each of the plurality of steam injection locations **220**.

(59) One of the plurality of steam injection locations **220** is a primary steam injection location **222** located to inject at least a portion of the steam **128** into the primary air **152**. The steam **128** can be injected into the primary air **152** at a steam flow rate to achieve a desired water-to-air ratio (WAR) in the primary air **152**. More specifically, as depicted in FIG. 3A, the primary steam injection location **222** is positioned to inject primary steam **232** into the mixing chamber **146** to mix with the primary air **152** before flowing through the mixer assembly **140** and upstream of the primary combustion zone **135**. As will be discussed further below, the primary steam **232** is a portion of the steam **128** being injected into the core air flow path **33**. The primary steam injection location **222** may also be referred to herein as an upstream steam injection location. By injecting the steam **128** into the mixing chamber **146**, the steam **128** may also be mixed with the dilution air **154** and the HPT cooling air **158**, as will be discussed further below.

(60) The steam **128** may be injected into the core air flow path **33** in a range of 5% to 50% of the mass flow through the core air flow path **33** (i.e., a WAR of 5% to 50%), and this parameter is referred to herein as a total WAR. To achieve the benefits of waste heat recovery discussed herein, this amount of steam **128** (water vapor) is beneficial when flowing through the turbine section **27** and, more specifically, the HPT **28** and the LPT **30**. In addition, the desired total WAR may vary throughout the flight of the aircraft based on operating conditions. For example, a total WAR of about 25% may be desired at cruise conditions or at altitude conditions, but, during high-power operations, such as take off and climb, higher total WARs may be desired such as, for example, about 40%. At cruise conditions, the total WAR preferably may be from 5% to 30% and, more preferably, from 10% to 20%. At high-power conditions the total WAR preferably may be from 20% to 45% and, more preferably, from 30% to 40%.

(61) Introducing the steam amounts discussed above such that all of the steam **128** flows through the primary combustion zone **135**, may cause issues with the stability of the flame and the flame dynamics in the combustion chamber **130**. Preferably, the WAR of the primary air **152** flowing into the primary combustion zone **135** (primary air WAR) may be from 3% to 15% and, more preferably, from 5% to 10%. Keeping the primary air WAR less than 15%, such as less than 10%, helps maintain suitable flame stability and dynamics avoiding, for example, flame out under conditions where a high total WAR is desired. A primary air WAR of 3% or more, such as 5% or more, is preferred to maintain the stability of the flame and prevent hot spots within the combustor, particularly for highly-reactive fuels such as hydrogen. Additionally, primary air WAR values lower than 3% may not show any benefit, such as fuel burn improvement, to the system. With the flow rate of the primary steam **232** injected at the primary steam injection location **222** being limited to achieve the primary air WAR discussed above, the remaining portion of the steam **128** is injected into the core air flow path **33** at one or more locations downstream of the primary combustion zone **135**, which are referred to herein as downstream steam injection locations.

(62) With the steam **128** being injected into the mixing chamber **146**, some of the primary steam

232 will be combined with the dilution air **154** and the HPT cooling air **158** to be injected into the combustor **26** and into the HPT **28**, respectively, as a result of the natural division of the compressor discharge pressure air **150** between the multiple flow paths of the compressor discharge pressure air **150** downstream of the HPC **24**. In this way, the steam **128** is introduced into the core air flow path **33** at positions downstream of the primary combustion zone **135**, where the dilution air **154** and the HPT cooling air **158** flow into the hot gas path **78**. Under certain operating conditions, such as high-power conditions having a relatively high steam demand, however, this natural flow division may not be sufficient to keep the primary air WAR at the levels discussed above. Accordingly, the steam delivery assembly **212** is fluidly connected to the core air flow path **33** to inject the steam **128** at other downstream locations independently of the steam **128** being injected into the primary air **152**. In FIG. 3A, the solid arrows are used to illustrate a flow path of the steam **128**, the long-dashed lines are used to illustrate a flow of a mixture of compressed air **65** and the steam **128**, and the long-dash, double-dot lines are used to illustrate a flow of compressor bleed air **159**.

(63) The steam delivery assembly **212** may be fluidly connected to the HPT **28** to inject a portion of the steam **128** directly into the HPT **28**. For example, the steam delivery assembly **212** may be fluidly connected to outlets, such as orifices, formed in the HPT stator vanes **68** of the HPT **28** to selectively inject HP turbine nozzle steam **234** into the core air flow path **33**. This steam injection location is referred to herein as an HP turbine nozzle steam injection location **224**. The first steam injection system **200** includes one or more steam flow control valves that are used to selectively direct the steam **128** into the core air flow path **33**, and to control the distribution of the steam **128** between the different injection locations. Each of the steam flow control valves discussed herein is a flow control valve that controls the flow rate of the steam **128** through the flow control valve. The steam control valves may be proportional control valves that are positionable to direct the steam **128** in a proportion to a plurality of different locations, such as a three-way valve positionable to proportion the steam flowing through the steam flow control valve to one of two outlets.

Additionally, two or more flow control valves may be configured to produce a similar control, and such flow control valves may have a closed position and a plurality of open positions including a fully open position. The flow control valves may be electrically operable valves, hydraulically operable valves, or pneumatically operable valves. When the flow control valves are hydraulically operable, the hydraulic fluid may be suitable fluids of the turbine engine **10** including, for example, the fuel **67**, lubrication oil, and the like. As will be discussed in more detail below, these steam flow control valves are located in the steam delivery assembly **212** to direct a portion of the steam **128** into one or more steam injection locations **220** in the core air flow path **33**.

(64) As depicted in FIG. 3A, the first steam injection system **200** includes an HP turbine nozzle steam flow control valve **242** operable to control the flow of the HP turbine nozzle steam **234** into the HPT stator vanes **68**. While the HP turbine nozzle steam **234** may be injected as pure steam (without mixing with additional air), the HP turbine nozzle steam **234** may also be mixed with air, such as a portion of the dilution air **154**, using, for example one or more steam injector nozzles with an integrated venturi.

(65) The steam delivery assembly **212** may also be fluidly connected directly to the cooling passages formed in the HPT rotor blades **70**, bypassing the mixing chamber **146**, to inject a portion of the steam **128** (referred to herein as HP turbine blade steam **236**) into the HPT **28** via the HPT rotor blades **70**. The HP turbine blade steam **236** may be injected through openings (e.g., orifices) formed in the HPT rotor blades **70**. As depicted in FIG. 3A, the first steam injection system **200** includes an HP turbine blade steam flow control valve **244** operable to control the flow of the HP turbine blade steam **236** into the HPT rotor blades **70**. As with the HP turbine nozzle steam **234**, the HP turbine blade steam **236** may be injected into the HPT **28** as pure steam, but the HP turbine blade steam **236** may also be mixed with air, such as the HPT cooling air **158**. This steam injection location is referred to herein as an HP turbine blade steam injection location **226**.

(66) As noted above, the HPT **28** depicted in FIG. **3A** has one stage. If the HPT **28** has more than one stage, the HP turbine nozzle steam **234** and the HP turbine blade steam **236** may be directed through openings in any one or all of the stages.

(67) While having the total WAR of steam flowing through the HPT **28** is preferred, a portion of the steam **128**, referred to herein as LP turbine steam **238**, may be directed into the LPT **30** through openings formed in one or more of the LPT rotor blades **74**, such as, for example, the first stage LPT rotor. More specifically, the LPT rotor blade **74** may include cooling passages formed in the LPT rotor blade **74** through which cooling air, such as compressor bleed air **159** drawn from one of the stages of the HPC **24**, flows. The compressor bleed air **159** may then be discharged from the cooling air passages through a plurality of openings (e.g., orifices) formed in the LPT rotor blades **74**. Two different airflows of compressor bleed air **159** are depicted in FIG. **3A**, specifically, a high-pressure compressor bleed air **159a** and a low-pressure compressor bleed air **159b**. The high-pressure compressor bleed air **159a** is drawn from the later stages of the HPC **24** (e.g., stages six, seven, or eight) and the low-pressure compressor bleed air **159b** is drawn from the earlier stages of the HPC **24** (e.g., stages three or four). Accordingly, the high-pressure compressor bleed air **159a** has a higher pressure than the low-pressure compressor bleed air **159b**. The high-pressure compressor bleed air **159a** may be used to cool the first stages of the LPT **30**, and the low-pressure compressor bleed air **159b** may be used to cool the later stages of the LPT **30** and for other cooling uses, such as an aft sump **37**. As depicted in FIG. **3A**, the LP turbine steam **238** may be mixed with the compressor bleed air **159** and, more specifically, the high-pressure compressor bleed air **159a** to be discharged through the openings in the LPT rotor blade **74**. Alternatively, the LP turbine steam **238** may be injected as pure steam. Although described as being injected through the LPT rotor blades **74**, the LP turbine steam **238**, or a portion thereof, may be additionally or alternatively injected into the LPT **30** through the LPT stator vanes **72**. This steam injection location is referred to herein as an LP turbine steam injection location **228**. As depicted in FIG. **3A**, the first steam injection system **200** includes an LP turbine steam flow control valve **246** operable to control the flow of the LP turbine steam **238** into the LPT **30** and, more specifically the LPT rotor blades **74**, and additionally or alternatively the LPT stator vanes **72**.

(68) As depicted in FIG. **3A**, the steam **128** flows into the steam delivery assembly **212** through a steam inlet **214** and then flows in series through the LP turbine steam flow control valve **246**, the HP turbine nozzle steam flow control valve **242**, and the HP turbine blade steam flow control valve **244**, each of which is located in the steam delivery assembly **212**. As discussed above, these steam flow control valves may be proportional control valves. The steam **128** flowing into the steam inlet **214** reaches the first steam flow control valve, which, as depicted in FIG. **3A**, is the LP turbine steam flow control valve **246**, and a portion of the steam **128** may be directed by the LP turbine steam flow control valve **246** as the LP turbine steam **238** and the remaining steam flows to a second steam flow control valve. As depicted in FIG. **3A**, the second steam flow control valve is the HP turbine nozzle steam flow control valve **242**, and a portion of the steam may be directed by the HP turbine nozzle steam flow control valve **242** as the HP turbine nozzle steam **234**, with the remaining steam flowing to the third steam flow control valve. The third steam flow control valve is the HP turbine blade steam flow control valve **244** and a portion of the steam may be directed by the HP turbine blade steam flow control valve **244** as the HP turbine blade steam **236**, with the remaining steam being the primary steam **232**. Each of the steam flow control valves may thus be selectively operable to inject the steam **128** at a desired flow rate, a desired total WAR, or both, while maintaining the primary air WAR less than a threshold.

(69) The first steam injection system **200** also includes a controller **250**. The controller **250** may be a separate, standalone controller operable as described herein, or may be another controller of the turbine engine **10**, such as an engine controller. The engine controller may be a Full Authority Digital Engine Control (FADEC). The controller **250** is configured to operate various aspects of the first steam injection system **200**, including, in this embodiment, the HP turbine nozzle steam flow

control valve **242**, the HP turbine blade steam flow control valve **244**, and the LP turbine steam flow control valve **246**. In this embodiment, the controller **250** is a computing device having one or more processors **252** and one or more memories **254**. The processor **252** can be any suitable processing device, including, but not limited to, a microprocessor, a microcontroller, an integrated circuit, a logic device, a programmable logic controller (PLC), an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), and/or a Field Programmable Gate Array (FPGA). The memory **254** can include one or more computer-readable media, including, but not limited to, non-transitory computer-readable media, a computer-readable non-volatile medium (e.g., a flash memory), a RAM, a ROM, hard drives, flash drives, and/or other memory devices.

(70) The memory **254** can store information accessible by the processor **252**, including computer-readable instructions that can be executed by the processor **252**. The instructions can be any set of instructions or a sequence of instructions that, when executed by the processor **252**, causes the processor **252** and the controller **250** to perform operations. In some embodiments, the instructions can be executed by the processor **252** to cause the processor **252** to complete any of the operations and functions for which the controller **250** is configured, as will be described further below. The instructions can be software written in any suitable programming language, or can be implemented in hardware. Additionally, and/or alternatively, the instructions can be executed in logically and/or virtually separate threads on the processor **252**. The memory **254** can further store data that can be accessed by the processor **252**.

(71) The technology discussed herein makes reference to computer-based systems and actions taken by, and information sent to and from, computer-based systems. One of ordinary skill in the art will recognize that the inherent flexibility of computer-based systems allows for a great variety of possible configurations, combinations, and divisions of tasks and functionality between components and among components. For instance, processes discussed herein can be implemented using a single computing device or multiple computing devices working in combination. Databases, memory, instructions, and applications can be implemented on a single system or distributed across multiple systems. Distributed components can operate sequentially or in parallel.

(72) FIG. **3B** is a detail view similar to FIG. **3A** showing a portion of the turbo-engine **16** and a second steam injection system **201** according to another preferred embodiment. In the second steam injection system **201** depicted in FIG. **3B**, the primary steam **232** is injected at an alternate primary steam injection location **222a**. More specifically, the primary steam **232** is injected in the mixer assembly **140**. In this way, the primary steam **232** may be injected directly into the primary combustion zone **135**. Such a configuration may be used as an alternative to the configuration shown in FIG. **3A** or be used in addition to the configuration shown in FIG. **3A** such that a portion of the primary steam **232** is injected into the mixing chamber **146** and another portion is injected into the mixer assembly **140**. The configuration of the second steam injection system **201** shown in FIG. **3B** is otherwise the same as the configuration shown in FIG. **3A**, and the description of the components and features of the first steam injection system **200** also applies to the second steam injection system **201**.

(73) FIGS. **4** to **6** depict additional embodiments of a steam injection system that may be used in the turbine engine **10** discussed herein. In the following discussion, the same reference numerals will be used to refer to the same or similar components among the steam injection systems discussed herein, including the first steam injection system **200** discussed above. The discussion of these components in one embodiment applies to the other embodiments and a detailed description of such components and features is omitted from the following discussion. In addition, FIGS. **4** to **6** depict the primary steam **232** being injected into the mixing chamber **146**, but the configuration shown in FIG. **3B** may also be used in these embodiments.

(74) FIG. **4** is a detail view similar to FIG. **3A** showing a portion of the turbo-engine **16** and a third steam injection system **202** according to another preferred embodiment. In the first steam injection system **200**, a plurality of steam flow control valves is used to direct the flow of steam **128** from

the steam inlet **214** to each of the plurality of steam injection locations **220**, but other arrangements of the steam flow control valves may be used other than as depicted in FIG. 3A. In the third steam injection system **202** depicted in FIG. 4, for example, one steam flow control valve, referred to herein as a proportional steam flow control valve **260**, may be used. The proportional steam flow control valve **260** includes the steam inlet **214** for the steam **128** to flow into the proportional steam flow control valve **260**. The proportional steam flow control valve **260** includes a plurality of outlets, with each outlet corresponding to one of the plurality of steam injection locations **220** discussed above. The controller **250** may be operatively coupled to the proportional steam flow control valve **260** to position the valve and to adjust the portion of the steam **128** flowing to each of the plurality of steam injection locations **220** (e.g., adjust the amounts or flow rate of the primary steam **232**, the HP turbine nozzle steam **234**, the HP turbine blade steam **236**, and the LP turbine steam **238**).

(75) FIG. 5 is a detail view similar to FIG. 3A showing a portion of the turbo-engine **16** and a fourth steam injection system **203** according to another preferred embodiment. As discussed above, a portion of the steam **128** may be injected into the combustion chamber **130** at a position downstream of the primary combustion zone **135**. In the first steam injection system **200** this steam was mixed with the dilution air **154**, but, in this embodiment, a portion of the steam **128**, as combustor liner steam **270**, flows into a combustor liner passage **272** around the combustor liner, such as the outer liner **134** as depicted in FIG. 5, and then into the combustion chamber **130** through steam holes **274** located in the outer liner **134** downstream of the primary combustion zone **135**. In addition to adding mass flow to the combustion gases **66**, the combustor liner steam **270** may be used to help cool the combustor liner, such as the outer liner **134**. The steam holes **274** are another one of the plurality of steam injection locations **220**, and the fifth steam injection system **204** includes a combustor liner steam flow control valve **276** operable in a manner similar to the HP turbine nozzle steam flow control valve **242**, the HP turbine blade steam flow control valve **244**, or the LP turbine steam flow control valve **246** discussed above.

(76) In this embodiment, the combustor liner passage **272** may also be a flow passage for the dilution air **154**. A blocker door **278** may be positioned at an upstream end of the combustor liner passage **272**. The blocker door **278** is selectively operable to regulate the flow of the dilution air **154** into the combustor liner passage **272**. The blocker door **278** may be moved by a suitable movement mechanism between a fully closed position, blocking the flow of the dilution air **154** into the combustor liner passage **272**, and a fully open position, allowing the dilution air **154** to flow into the combustor liner passage **272**. In some embodiments, the blocker door **278** may include a plurality of intermediate positions regulating the flow of the dilution air **154** into the combustor liner passage **272**. Closing the blocker door **278** reduces the flow of dilution air **154** into the combustor liner passage **272** and increases the amount of air flowing as primary air **154** and lowers the primary WAR. Accordingly, operation of the blocker door **27**, either in combination with the combustor liner steam flow control valve **276** or separately, may control the primary WAR. The blocker door **278** may be operated by a suitable movement mechanism such as an actuator (e.g., a hydraulic actuator or an electric actuator) or motor.

(77) FIG. 6 is a detail view similar to FIG. 3A showing a portion of the turbo-engine **16** and a fifth steam injection system **204** according to another preferred embodiment. Under some conditions, liquid water (e.g., water **124** (FIG. 2)) may be injected into the core air flow path **33** in addition to (or instead of) the steam **128**. The steam delivery assembly **212** of the fifth steam injection system **204** depicted in FIG. 6 is fluidly connected to a water source, such as the water tank **112** of the steam system **100**, as depicted in FIG. 2. Alternatively, the water source (e.g., water tank **112**) may be separate from the steam system **100**.

(78) The steam delivery assembly **212** includes a water inlet **216**, and an inlet flow control valve **218** fluidly connected to the steam inlet **214** and the water inlet **216**. The inlet flow control valve **218** may be a proportional flow control valve that controls the amount of the steam **128** and the

water **124** flowing into the steam delivery assembly **212** from the steam inlet **214** and the water inlet **216**, respectively. The inlet flow control valve **218** may be operated in a manner similar to the steam flow control valves discussed above. When receiving the water **124**, the steam delivery assembly **212** fluidly couples and distributes the water **124** to the plurality of steam injection locations to inject the water **124** at the plurality of steam injection locations. The inlet flow control valve **218** may be used to control the relative amounts of the water **124** and the steam **128** being distributed by the steam delivery assembly **212**, and subsequently injected into the core air flow path **33**. The inlet flow control valve **218** may be positioned (i.e., operated) to provide either pure steam **128**, water **124**, or a mixture of both.

(79) FIG. 7 is a detail view similar to FIG. 3A showing a portion of the turbo-engine **16** and a sixth steam injection system **205** according to another preferred embodiment. Instead of injecting all of the steam **128** into the core air flow path **33**, some of the steam **128** may be diverted from the core air flow path **33**, reducing the total amount of steam **128** injected into the core air flow path **33**. Accordingly, each of the HP turbine nozzle steam flow control valve **242**, the HP turbine blade steam flow control valve **244**, and the LP turbine steam flow control valve **246** is fluidly connected to a vent **280** to vent or to bypass the core air flow path **33**, and each of these steam flow control valves is operable to direct at least a portion of the steam **128** to the vent **280**. The vent **280** may discharge the unwanted steam **128** overboard or back into the steam system **100** such as into the condenser **104**, for example, to be recovered by the steam system **100**.

(80) By injecting the steam **128** into the core air flow path **33** at the plurality of steam injection locations **220** with any one of the steam injection systems discussed above, the WAR may be selectively controlled along the core air flow path **33**. The core air may have a lower WAR in the downstream sections of the core air flow path **33** and, more specifically, the hot gas path **78**, with additional steam **128** being added to increase the WAR as the combustion gases **66** flow into the turbine section **27**. More specifically, the primary air WAR may be maintained below a threshold to maintain the stability and the dynamics of the flame in the primary combustion zone **135** of the combustion chamber **130**, and the primary air WAR threshold may be, for example the upper bound of the ranges discussed above. More preferably, the primary air WAR may be maintained within the ranges discussed above. With the primary air WAR being maintained in the desirable ranges, additional steam **128** may be added downstream to achieve a desired total WAR that is higher than the primary air WAR to provide for efficient operation of the turbine engine **10**.

(81) The steam injection systems and the turbine engine **10** discussed herein may be controlled using the following methods. The following discussion will generally reference the first steam injection system **200** shown in FIG. 3A, but is applicable to the other steam injection systems discussed herein. These methods may be implemented by the controller **250** and the controller **250** may be configured to perform the steps of the method discussed below. Additional details of the method are described above relative to the operation and the description of the aforementioned components.

(82) The method of operating the turbine engine **10** may include controlling the amount of steam injected at the upstream steam injection location (i.e., the primary steam injection location **222** or the alternate primary steam injection location **222a** (FIG. 3B)) to maintain the WAR of primary air **152** below the primary air water-to-air ratio threshold. The method may also include controlling the amount of steam injected at one or more of the downstream steam injection locations, such as those discussed above, to achieve the total water-to-air ratio in the core air flow path at a position downstream of the combustor. The method may include selectively controlling any one of the steam flow control valves discussed above, to selectively provide the steam **128** in the desired WARs.

(83) The method of operating the turbine engine **10** may further include determining a desired total WAR for the core air **64** flowing through the core air flow path **33**. This determination may be based on a desired throttle position or other indication of a desired power level of the turbine

engine **10**. When the method is executed by the controller **250**, the controller **250** may be configured to receive an input, such as an input indicating the power level, and determine the desired total WAR based on the received input. This input may be, for example, a throttle input. Additionally or alternatively, the controller **250** may be coupled to one or more sensors **256**, such as a plurality of sensors. Such sensors **256** may be, for example, temperature sensors, pressure sensors, or flow sensors. The sensors **256** may be positioned at various suitable locations within the turbine engine **10** including within the core air flow path **33**. For example, one sensor **256** of the plurality of sensors may be positioned upstream of the combustor **26**, such as at compressor discharge outlet **144**, in the mixing chamber **146**, or part of the mixer assembly **140**. Another sensor **256** of the plurality of sensors may be positioned in the hot gas path **78** (i.e., flow path of the combustion gases **66**) downstream of the combustor **26**, such as at the nozzle (inlet) or the outlet of the HPT **28** or the LPT **30**. The controller **250** may receive the input from the one or more sensors **256** and determine the power level of the turbine engine **10** or flow rate of the core air **64** based on the input received from the sensors **256**.

(84) When the steam injection system includes a vent **280**, such as the sixth steam injection system **205** shown in FIG. 7, the method may also include, when the total steam provided is more than the desired total WAR, or the method may include operating one or more of the steam control valves to divert at least a portion of the steam **128** to the vent **280**. The vent **280** may be particularly useful during a transient condition or a failure condition, such as flame out or in-flight engine restart. Injecting steam into the core air flow path **33** or at least the combustor **26** may create difficulties for reignition, and, thus, the method may include operating one or more of the steam control valves to divert the steam **128** to the vent **280** when a failure condition has occurred. The vent **280** may be fluidly coupled to an opening to vent the steam **128** overboard, such as through one of the exhaust nozzles (e.g., the core exhaust nozzles **32** (FIG. 1) or the fan bypass nozzle **76** (FIG. 1)) or, alternatively, to vent the steam **128** back into the steam system **100** (FIG. 2), such as into the condenser **104** (FIG. 2).

(85) Further aspects of the present disclosure are provided by the subject matter of the following clauses.

(86) A turbine engine for an aircraft. The turbine engine includes a turbo-engine, a fan having a fan shaft coupled to the turbo-engine, and a steam system. The turbo-engine includes a core air flow path for core air to flow therethrough, a combustor, an engine shaft, and a turbine. The combustor is positioned in the core air flow path to receive compressed air and fluidly coupled to a fuel source to receive fuel. The fuel is injected into the combustor to mix with the compressed air to generate a fuel and air mixture. The fuel and air mixture is combusted in a primary combustion zone of the combustor to generate combustion gases. The turbine is located downstream of the combustor to receive the combustion gases and to cause the turbine to rotate. The turbine is coupled to the engine shaft. The steam system extracts water from the combustion gases and vaporizes the water to generate steam. The steam system is fluidly coupled to the core air flow path at a plurality of steam injection locations to selectively inject the steam into the core air flow path at each of the plurality of steam injection locations to add mass flow to the core air. The plurality of steam injection locations include (i) an upstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path at the primary combustion zone of the combustor or upstream thereof and (ii) a downstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path downstream of the primary combustion zone. The steam system includes a steam flow control valve operable to change a distribution of the steam being injected into the core air flow path at the plurality of steam injection locations.

(87) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the downstream steam injection location is one downstream steam injection location of a plurality of downstream steam injection locations.

(88) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam flow control valve is a proportional steam flow control valve fluidly connected to each downstream steam injection

location of the plurality of downstream steam injection locations, the proportional steam flow control valve being operable to control the distribution of the steam to each of the plurality of downstream steam injection locations.

(89) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam flow control valve is fluidly connected to the upstream steam injection location to control the distribution of the steam to the upstream steam injection location.

(90) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam flow control valve is one steam flow control valve of a plurality of the steam flow control valves operable to change the distribution of the steam being injected into the core air flow path by the plurality of steam injection locations.

(91) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbine is a high-pressure turbine, the downstream steam injection location being in the high-pressure turbine.

(92) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a high-pressure turbine steam flow control valve to control the flow of steam to the high-pressure turbine.

(93) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the downstream steam injection location being the plurality of rotor blades.

(94) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein cooling air is provided to the plurality of rotor blades, the steam being mixed with the cooling air.

(95) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a plurality of stator vanes, the downstream steam injection location being the plurality of stator vanes.

(96) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the plurality of rotor blades being downstream of the plurality of stator vanes.

(97) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein cooling air is provided to the plurality of stator vanes, the steam being mixed with the cooling air.

(98) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbo-engine includes a high-pressure compressor positioned in the core air flow path upstream of the combustor to generate the compressed air.

(99) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the engine shaft is a high-pressure shaft.

(100) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the high-pressure compressor is driven by the high-pressure shaft to compress the core air flowing through the core air flow path and to generate the compressed air.

(101) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbo-engine includes a low-pressure compressor positioned in the core air flow path upstream of the high-pressure compressor to generate the compressed air.

(102) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbo-engine includes a low-pressure turbine positioned in the core air flow path downstream of the high-pressure turbine to receive the combustion gases and to cause the turbine to rotate.

(103) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbo-engine includes a low-pressure shaft, the low-pressure turbine coupled to the low-pressure shaft.

(104) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the downstream steam injection location in the high-pressure turbine is one downstream steam injection location of a plurality of downstream steam injection locations.

(105) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein another one of the plurality of downstream steam injection locations is in the low-pressure turbine.

(106) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the low-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the downstream steam injection location being the plurality of rotor blades.

- (107) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein another one of the plurality of downstream steam injection locations is a portion of the combustor downstream of the primary combustion zone.
- (108) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the combustor includes a combustor liner, the downstream steam injection location being holes formed in the combustor liner.
- (109) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbo-engine includes a compressor positioned in the core air flow path upstream of the combustor to compress core air to generate the compressed air.
- (110) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the compressor is driven by the high-pressure shaft to compress the core air flowing through the core air flow path and to generate the compressed air.
- (111) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbo-engine includes a mixing chamber positioned upstream of the combustor and downstream of the compressor to receive the compressed air, the upstream steam injection location being the mixing chamber.
- (112) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the steam is mixed with air in the mixing chamber to generate a steam-air mixture.
- (113) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein a portion of the steam-air mixture is provided to the combustor as primary air.
- (114) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein a portion of the steam-air mixture is injected into the combustion gases downstream of the primary combustion zone.
- (115) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbine is a high-pressure turbine, the portion of the steam-air mixture injected into the combustion gases being injected in the high-pressure turbine.
- (116) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the portion of the steam-air mixture injected into the combustion gases being injected through the plurality of rotor blades.
- (117) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a plurality of stator vanes, the portion of the steam-air mixture injected into the combustion gases being injected through the plurality of stator vanes.
- (118) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein a portion of the steam-air mixture is injected into the combustion chamber downstream of the primary combustion zone.
- (119) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the combustor includes a combustor liner, the portion of the steam-air mixture injected into the combustion chamber downstream of the primary combustion zone being injected through holes formed in the combustor liner.
- (120) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the downstream steam injection location is a portion of the combustor downstream of the primary combustion zone.
- (121) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the combustor includes a combustor liner, the downstream steam injection location being holes formed in the combustor liner.
- (122) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the turbine is a low-pressure turbine, the downstream steam injection location being in the low-pressure turbine.
- (123) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the low-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the downstream steam injection location being the plurality of rotor blades.
- (124) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a steam delivery assembly including a steam inlet to receive the steam generated by steam system and a water inlet fluidly coupled to a water source to receive water from the water source.
- (125) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the steam delivery assembly is fluidly coupled to the plurality of steam injection locations to inject the steam and the water into the core air flow path at the plurality of steam injection locations.
- (126) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam flow control valve is located

in the steam delivery assembly and operable to change the distribution of the steam, the water, or both being injected into the core air flow path.

(127) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam delivery assembly further includes an inlet flow control valve fluidly connected to the steam inlet and the water inlet, and is operable to control relative amounts of the water and the steam being distributed by the steam delivery assembly.

(128) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the water source is a water tank.

(129) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes the water tank.

(130) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the water tank is an accumulator positioned downstream of the water separator to collect and to store water.

(131) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a vent, and the steam flow control valve is fluidly connected to the vent and operable to direct at least a portion of the steam to the vent, bypassing the core air flow path.

(132) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, further comprising a controller operatively coupled to the steam flow control valve to adjust the position of the steam flow control valve.

(133) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the controller is configured to position the steam flow control valve to distribute the steam to the plurality of steam injection locations to provide a desired total water-to-air ratio for the core air flowing through the core air flow path.

(134) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the controller is configured to maintain a water-to-air ratio of primary air flowing into the primary combustion zone below a primary air water-to-air ratio threshold.

(135) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the primary air water-to-air ratio threshold is from 3% to 15%.

(136) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the primary air water-to-air ratio threshold is from 5% to 10%.

(137) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, further comprising a sensor located in the core air flow path and coupled to the controller, the controller being configured to receive an input from the sensor and to adjust the position the steam flow control valve based on the input received from the sensor.

(138) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, further comprising a plurality of sensors located in the core air flow path and coupled to the controller, the controller being configured to receive an input from each sensor of the plurality of sensors and to adjust the position of the steam flow control valve based on the input received from the plurality of sensors.

(139) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein one sensor of the plurality of sensors is positioned upstream of the combustor.

(140) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein one sensor of the plurality of sensors is positioned upstream of the combustor and downstream of a compressor.

(141) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein one sensor of the plurality of sensors is positioned in a flow path of the combustion gases downstream of the combustor.

(142) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein one sensor of the plurality of sensors is positioned in a flow path of the combustion gases downstream of the combustor and upstream of the turbine.

(143) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the engine shaft is a low-pressure shaft and the turbine is a low-pressure turbine.

(144) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the fan shaft is coupled to the low-pressure shaft to be driven by the low-pressure shaft.

(145) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, further comprising a nacelle circumferentially surrounding the fan.

(146) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the fan includes a plurality of fan blades

that rotates to generate a volume of air.

(147) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the nacelle defines a bypass airflow passage between the nacelle and the turbo-engine. The volume of air from the fan is split and flows into the bypass airflow passage as bypass air and flows into the core air flow path as the core air.

(148) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a boiler located downstream of the combustor, the boiler receiving the extracted water and being fluidly connected to the combustor to receive the combustion gases and to boil the water to generate the steam.

(149) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a steam turbine. The steam turbine is fluidly coupled to the boiler to receive the steam from the boiler and to cause the steam turbine to rotate.

(150) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the steam turbine is coupled to the engine shaft.

(151) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a steam delivery assembly fluidly coupled to the plurality of steam injection locations to inject the steam and the water into the core air flow path at the plurality of steam injection locations.

(152) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam delivery assembly includes a steam inlet to receive the steam generated by steam system.

(153) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam flow control valve is located in the steam delivery assembly and operable to change the distribution of the steam being injected into the core air flow path.

(154) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam delivery assembly is fluidly coupled to the steam system downstream of the steam turbine to receive the steam from the steam turbine.

(155) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a condenser downstream of the turbine to receive the combustion gases and to condense the water from the combustion gases.

(156) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the condenser is located downstream of the boiler.

(157) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the condenser is located in the bypass airflow passage for bypass air to cool the combustion gases and to condense the water from the combustion gases.

(158) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the steam system includes a water separator located downstream of the condenser, the water separator separating the water from an exhaust-water mixture.

(159) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, wherein the water separator is fluidly connected to the boiler to provide the water to the boiler.

(160) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, wherein the water separator is a cyclonic separator.

(161) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, further comprising a water pump in fluid communication with the water separator and with the boiler to direct the flow of water from the water separator into the boiler.

(162) A method of operating a turbine engine for an aircraft having a steam system.

(163) The method comprises injecting steam into a core air flow path at a plurality of steam injection locations. The plurality of steam injection locations includes (i) an upstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path at a primary combustion zone of a combustor or upstream thereof and (ii) a downstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path downstream of the primary combustion zone. The method also includes controlling the amount of steam injected at an upstream steam injection location to maintain the water-to-air ratio of primary air flowing into the primary combustion zone below a

primary air water-to-air ratio threshold, and controlling the amount of steam injected at the downstream steam injection location to achieve a desired total water-to-air ratio in the core air flow path at a position downstream of the combustor.

(164) The method of the preceding clause, wherein the primary air water-to-air ratio threshold is from 3% to 15%.

(165) The method of any preceding clause, wherein the primary air water-to-air ratio threshold is from 5% to 10%.

(166) The method of any preceding clause, further comprising determining the desired total water-to-air ratio for core air flowing through a core air flow path of the turbine engine.

(167) The method of any preceding clause operating the turbine engine of any preceding clause.

(168) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, further comprising a controller configured to execute the method of any preceding clause.

(169) Although the foregoing description is directed to the preferred embodiments, other variations and modifications will be apparent to those skilled in the art, and may be made without departing from the spirit or the scope of the disclosure. Moreover, features described in connection with one embodiment may be used in conjunction with other embodiments, even if not explicitly stated above.

Claims

1. A turbine engine for an aircraft, the turbine engine comprising: a turbo-engine including: a core air flow path for core air to flow therethrough; a combustor positioned in the core air flow path to receive compressed air and fluidly coupled to a fuel source to receive fuel, the fuel being injected into the combustor to mix with the compressed air to generate a fuel and air mixture, the fuel and air mixture being combusted in a primary combustion zone of the combustor to generate combustion gases; an engine shaft; and a turbine located downstream of the combustor to receive the combustion gases and to cause the turbine to rotate, the turbine coupled to the engine shaft; a fan having a fan shaft coupled to the turbo-engine; and a steam system extracting water from the combustion gases and vaporizing the water to generate steam, the steam system including: a steam delivery assembly with a steam inlet to receive the steam generated by the steam system, and a water inlet fluidly coupled to a water source to receive water from the water source, the water inlet being disposed in the steam delivery assembly to add water to the steam in the steam delivery assembly, the steam delivery assembly being fluidly coupled to the core air flow path at a plurality of steam injection locations to selectively inject the steam and the water into the core air flow path at each of the plurality of steam injection locations to add mass flow to the core air, the plurality of steam injection locations including (i) an upstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path at the primary combustion zone of the combustor or upstream thereof, and (ii) a downstream steam injection location located to inject steam into the core air flow path downstream of the primary combustion zone; and a steam flow control valve located in the steam delivery assembly and operable to change a distribution of the steam, the water, or both, being injected into the core air flow path at the plurality of steam injection locations.

2. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the turbo-engine includes: a compressor positioned in the core air flow path upstream of the combustor to compress core air to generate the compressed air; and a mixing chamber positioned upstream of the combustor and downstream of the compressor to receive the compressed air, the upstream steam injection location being the mixing chamber.

3. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the steam flow control valve is one steam flow control valve of a plurality of the steam flow control valves operable to change the distribution of the steam, the water, or both being injected into the core air flow path by the plurality of steam injection locations.

4. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the steam system includes a vent, and the steam flow

control valve is fluidly connected to the vent and operable to direct at least a portion of the steam to the vent bypassing the core air flow path.

5. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the steam delivery assembly further includes an inlet flow control valve fluidly connected to the steam inlet and the water inlet and operable to control relative amounts of the water and the steam being distributed by the steam delivery assembly.

6. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the downstream steam injection location is a portion of the combustor downstream of the primary combustion zone.

7. The turbine engine of claim 6, wherein the combustor includes a combustor liner, the downstream steam injection location being holes formed in the combustor liner.

8. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the turbine is a low-pressure turbine, the downstream steam injection location being in the low-pressure turbine.

9. The turbine engine of claim 8, wherein the low-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the downstream steam injection location being the plurality of rotor blades.

10. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the downstream steam injection location is one downstream steam injection location of a plurality of downstream steam injection locations.

11. The turbine engine of claim 10, wherein the steam flow control valve is a proportional steam flow control valve fluidly connected to each downstream steam injection location of the plurality of downstream steam injection locations, the proportional steam flow control valve being operable to control the distribution of the steam, the water, or both to each of the plurality of downstream steam injection locations.

12. The turbine engine of claim 11, wherein the steam flow control valve is fluidly connected to the upstream steam injection location to control the distribution of the steam, the water, or both to the upstream steam injection location.

13. The turbine engine of claim 1, wherein the turbine is a high-pressure turbine, the downstream steam injection location being in the high-pressure turbine.

14. The turbine engine of claim 13, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the downstream steam injection location being the plurality of rotor blades.

15. The turbine engine of claim 13, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a plurality of stator vanes, the downstream steam injection location being the plurality of stator vanes.

16. The turbine engine of claim 15, wherein the high-pressure turbine includes a turbine rotor including a plurality of rotor blades, the plurality of rotor blades being downstream of the plurality of stator vanes.

17. The turbine engine of claim 1, further comprising a controller operatively coupled to the steam flow control valve to adjust the position of the steam flow control valve, the controller being configured to position the steam flow control valve to distribute the steam to the plurality of steam injection locations to provide a desired total water-to-air ratio for the core air flowing through the core air flow path and to maintain a water-to-air ratio of primary air flowing into the primary combustion zone below a primary air water-to-air ratio threshold.

18. The turbine engine of claim 17, further comprising a sensor located in the core air flow path and coupled to the controller, the controller being configured to receive an input from the sensor and to adjust the position the steam flow control valve based on the input received from the sensor.

19. The turbine engine of claim 17, further comprising a plurality of sensors located in the core air flow path and coupled to the controller, the controller being configured to receive an input from each sensor of the plurality of sensors and to adjust the position of the steam flow control valve based on the input received from the plurality of sensors, one sensor of the plurality of sensors being positioned upstream of the combustor and another sensor of the plurality of sensors being positioned in a flow path of the combustion gases downstream of the combustor.

20. The turbine engine of claim 17, wherein the primary air water-to-air ratio threshold is from 3% to 15%.
